

Bitcoin? Virtual Money? Revolution? Stop! What's going on here?

Who could have predicted ten years ago that a virtual currency system designed by an anonymous figure from the internet would suddenly become an issue for international economies? Well, we tried our best but as 2013 demonstrated, Bitcoin and the world of virtual currencies are a roller coaster ride of the unpredictable.

As newspapers the world over start carrying stories about Bitcoin and moving them from the technology pages to the finance pages, many people across the globe wait for Bitcoin to become truly mainstream. Even Indian innovators are showing interest in the Bitcoin phenomenon and attempting to bring it to the common consumer. However, faced with government restrictions and murkiness about how the Bitcoin system works they are faced with many obstacles.

The Bitcoin system is a relatively new phenomenon and it offers many rewards for participants at different levels - from those who simply use it as a currency to those who wish to become an integral part of its mining community. And as this system continues to operate we will discover its many flaws and strengths. It's very likely that the Bitcoin of today will undergo many changes in the years to come but it is our undisputed belief that Bitcoin is sure to become part of the future internet.

This issue of Fast Track seeks to cover the broad range of questions that face you, our readers, regarding the different aspects of Bitcoin and how you can be a part of it.